

Pillar 2: GA4 Stream & Cross-Domain Setup

Multi-Subdomain Session Stitching, Telemetry Governance & Stream Configuration | Apple Store Measurement Setup

PROPERTY NAME

Apple Store GA4 Demo

MEASUREMENT ID

G-X3R766JV6K

LINKED DOMAINS

apple.com · store.apple.com

DATA RETENTION

14 Months (Extended)

01 Context & Scope

The executive narrative



PROJECT OBJECTIVE

Configure the GA4 Web Data Stream so a single, coherent user journey survives movement across multiple digital storefronts and regional subdomains, rather than fragmenting into disconnected sessions at every subdomain boundary.

Modern storefronts rarely live on one hostname: a marketing campaign might land a visitor on [apple.com](#), while checkout completes on [store.apple.com](#). Without deliberate stream configuration, GA4 treats that handoff as two separate visits from two separate users, which quietly destroys attribution the moment a session crosses the subdomain boundary. **Session stitching** is the mechanism that keeps the Client ID intact across that handoff, so a single visitor who starts on a landing page and finishes at checkout is still measured as one continuous journey, not two disconnected fragments.

02 Stream Architecture & Cross-Domain Linker Rules

How Client IDs survive a subdomain handoff



Native Client ID Preservation

CROSS-DOMAIN

GA4 preserves Client IDs natively across subdomains that share the same root domain, with no cookie override scripts or manual linker configuration required for same-root traffic.



Configure Your Domains — Contains Match

AUTO-LINKING RULE

Both [apple.com](#) and [store.apple.com](#) are registered under the Configure Your Domains panel using **Contains** match logic, so any outbound link between the two automatically appends the `_gl` query parameter carrying the Client ID forward.



Enhanced Measurement Tuning

AUTOMATED TELEMETRY

Outbound clicks, site search, and video engagement are enabled under Enhanced Measurement, so this baseline telemetry is captured automatically without a single custom GTM trigger.

Keeping the data long enough, and clean enough, to trust



Extended Data Retention

GOVERNANCE

Event data retention was raised from the 2-month default to **14 months**, giving Exploration reports enough historical depth to support year-over-year and seasonal analysis without hitting a retention wall.



Internal Traffic Definition

IP FILTERING

Internal developer and employee IP ranges are registered under Define Internal Traffic and tagged accordingly, keeping QA and staging activity out of production reporting rather than inflating real customer counts.



Referral Exclusion List

ATTRIBUTION PROTECTION

Third-party payment gateways, PayPal and the Apple Pay web checkout flow, are added to the referral exclusion list, so a payment redirect isn't misread as a brand-new acquisition channel and doesn't overwrite the original campaign's credit.

04 Implementation Proof

Visual asset from the demo property

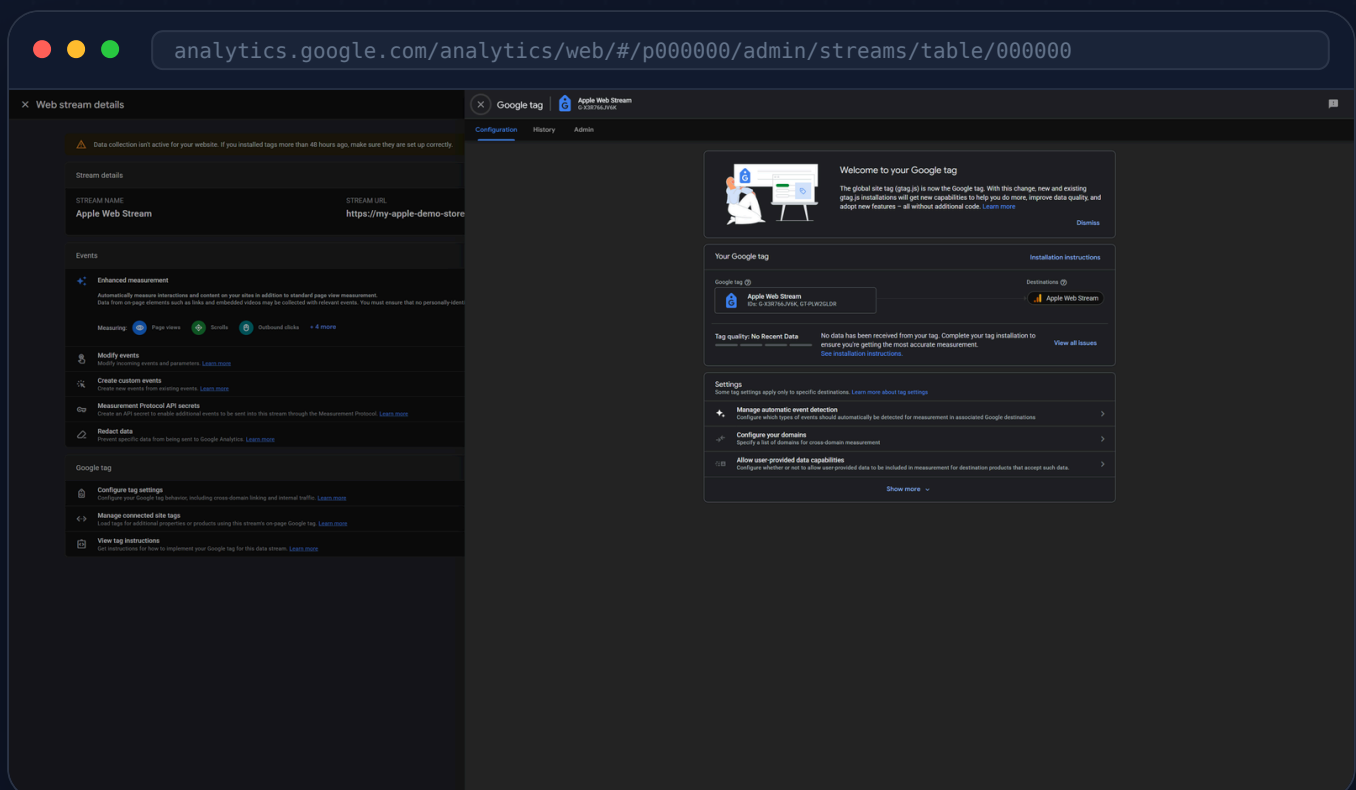


FIG. 3 GA4 Web Stream Configuration — confirms the Apple Web Stream under Measurement ID G-X3R766JV6K, with the Google tag configuration panel surfaced, including the cross-domain linking and internal traffic controls used to implement the domain rules described in Section 2.